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Eisenberg

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(54) **FRENCH COFFEE PRESS**

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(52) **U.S. Cl.**
CPC *A47J 31/20* (2013.01); *A47J 31/38* (2013.01); *A47J 31/44* (2013.01)

(58) **Field of Classification Search**
CPC *A47J 31/38*; *A47J 31/20*; *A47J 31/44*
USPC 99/297
See application file for complete search history.

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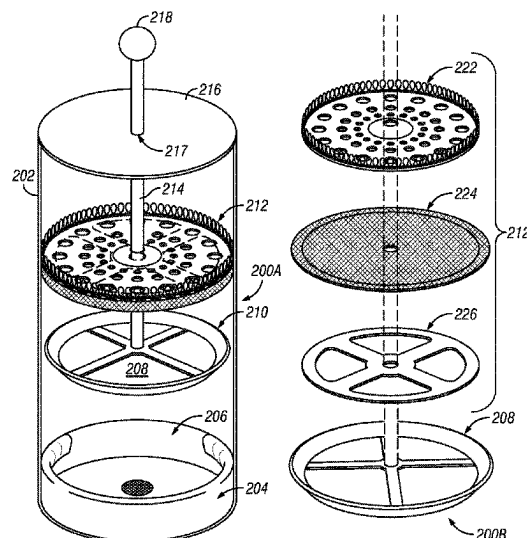
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(57) **ABSTRACT**

An improved French coffee press apparatus, system, and method that utilizes a locking ring to engage with a locking base that can be removed from the carafe, along with any coffee grounds. The locking ring is connected to the pressing rod, which also includes a filter system above the locking ring. The pressing rod fits through an opening in the carafe lid, and the carafe lid secures the liquid inside the carafe. The combination of the filtering system assists in the filtering and capture of any coffee grounds into the locking base for cleaning, and the locking ring assists in the removal of the locking base.

18 Claims, 10 Drawing Sheets



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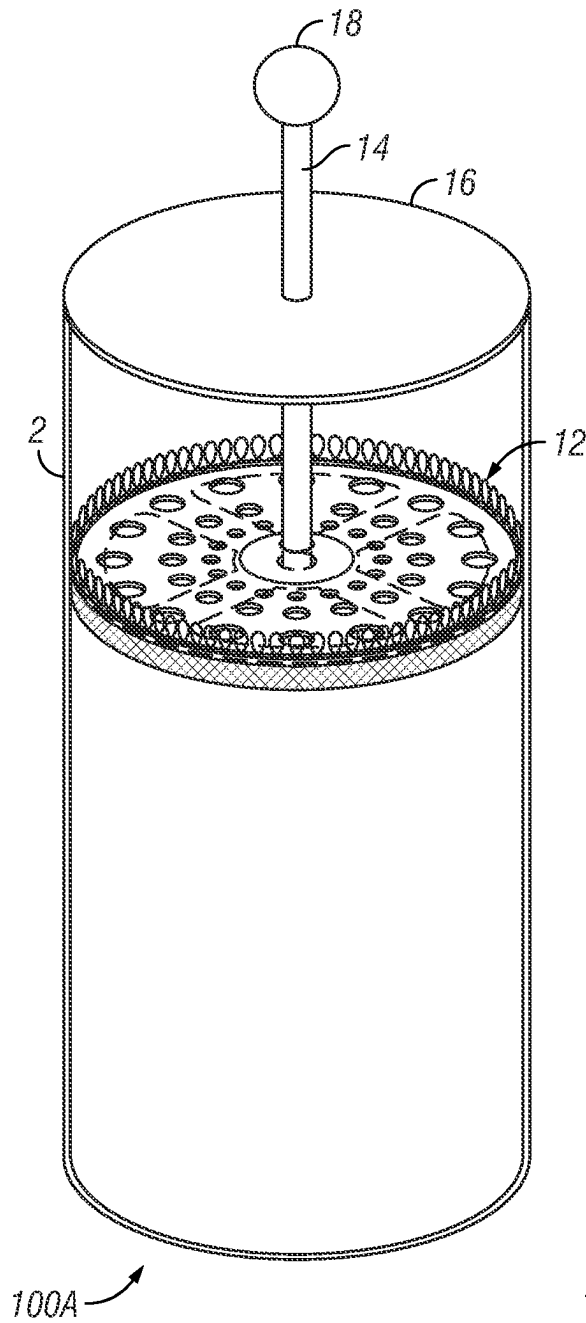


FIG. 1A
(Prior Art)

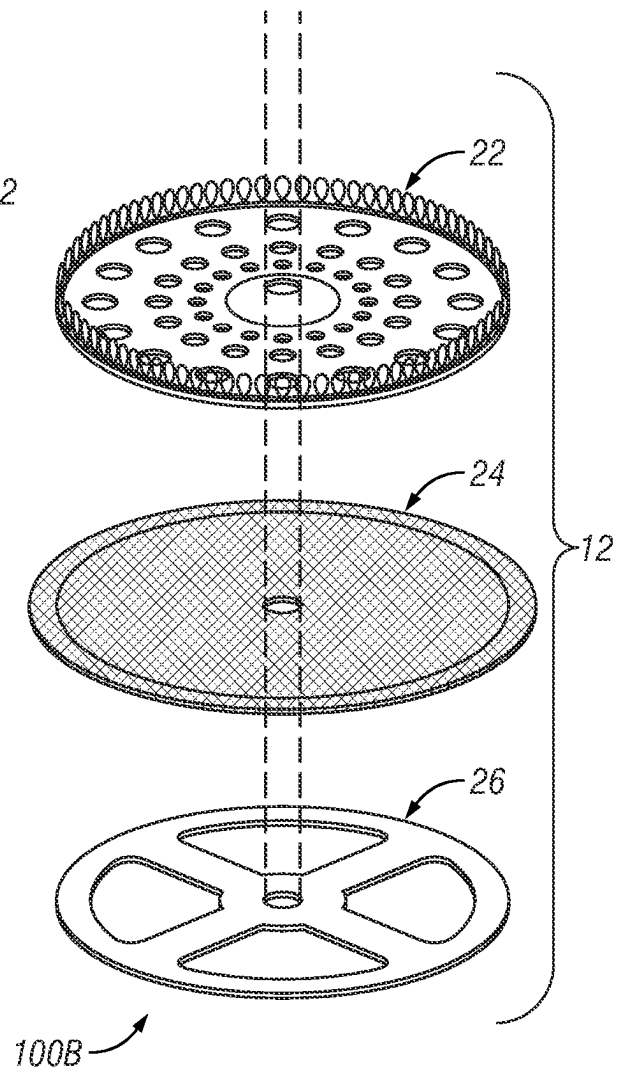


FIG. 1B
(Prior Art)

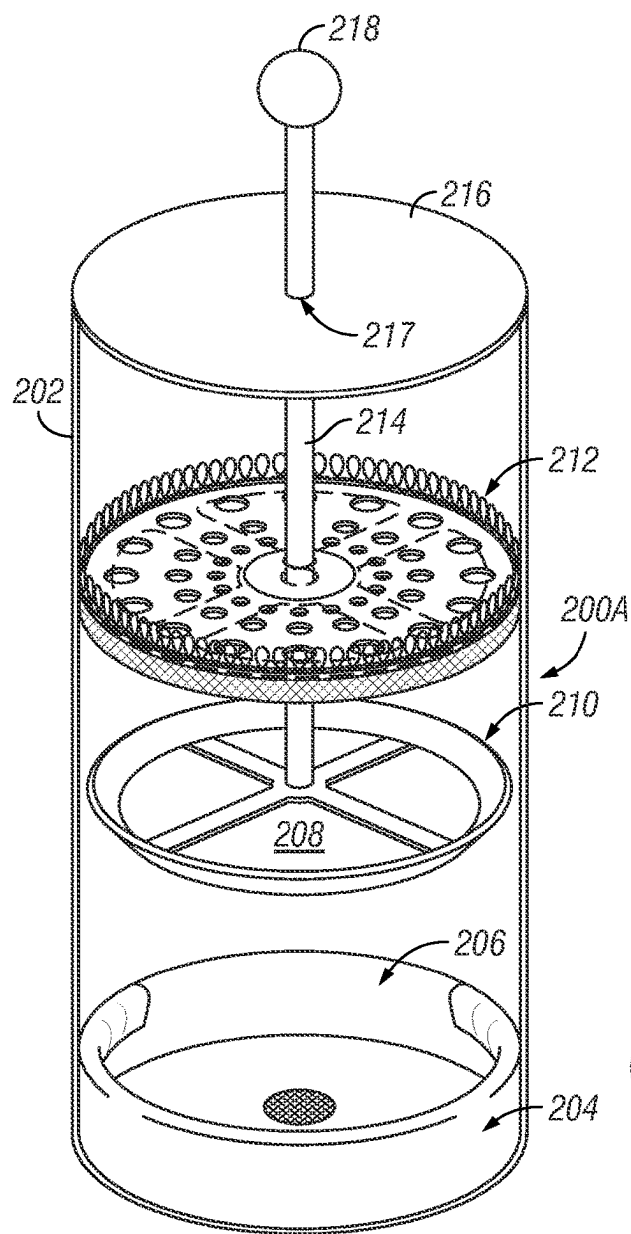


FIG. 2A

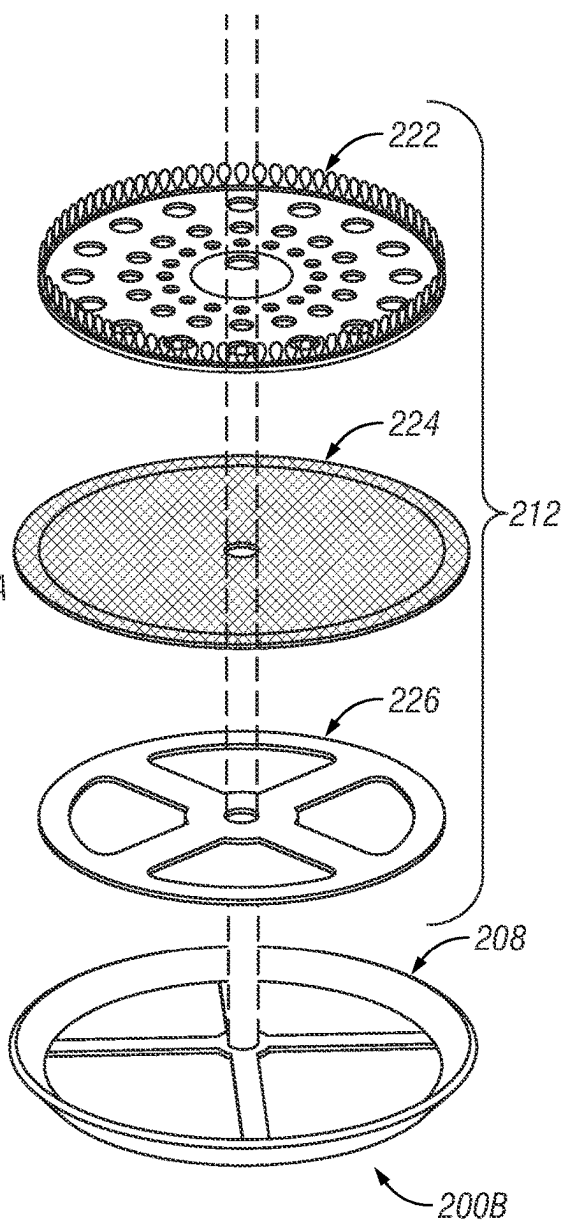


FIG. 2B

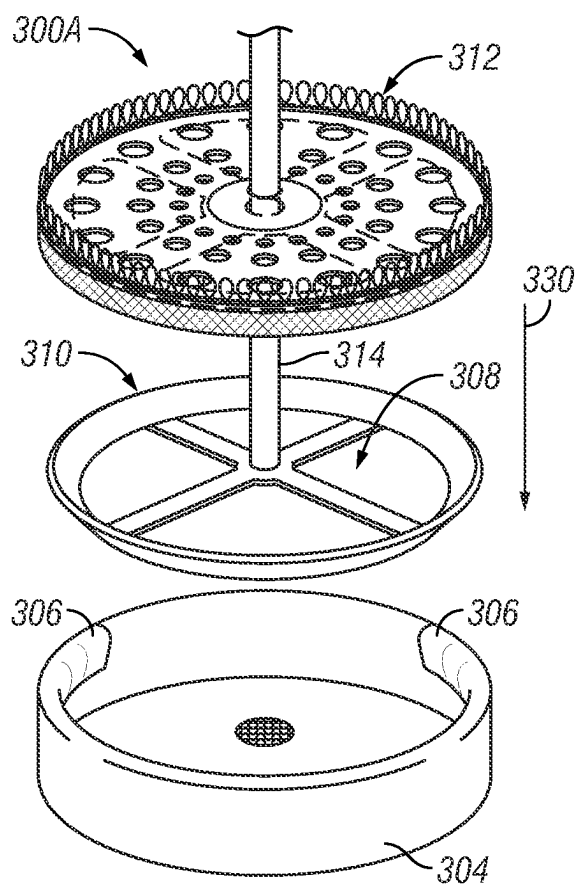


FIG. 3A

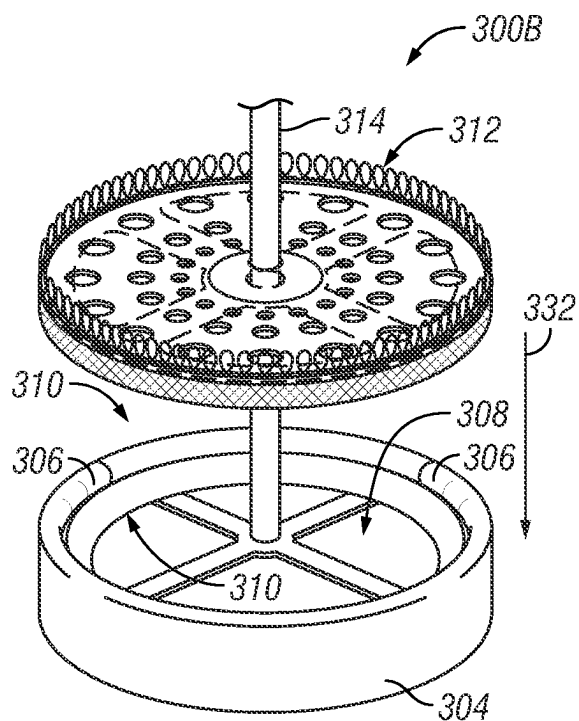


FIG. 3B

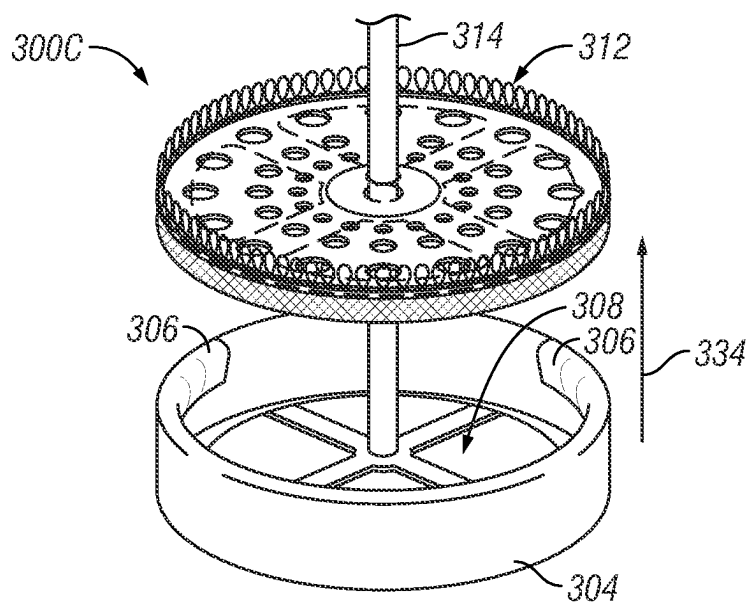


FIG. 3C

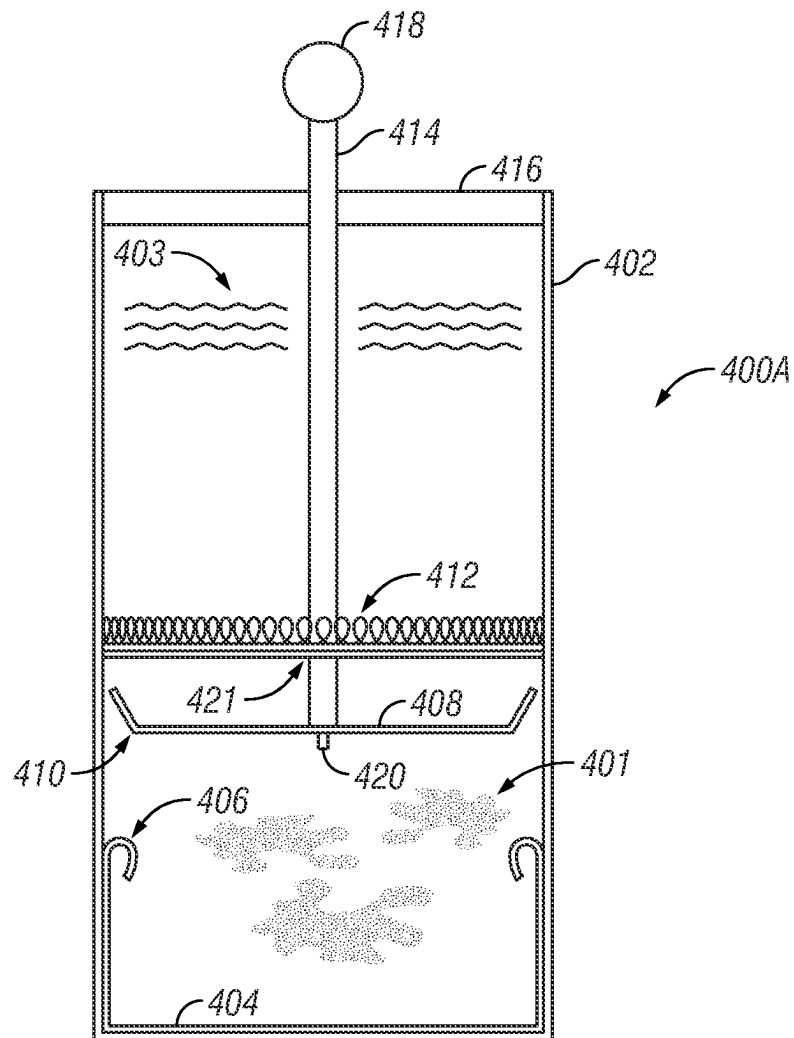


FIG. 4A

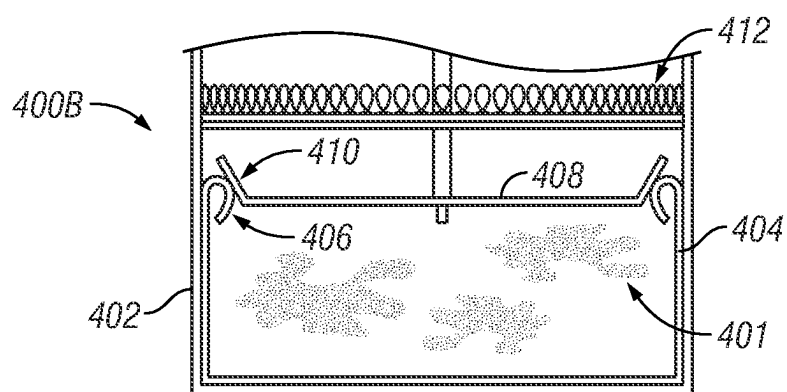
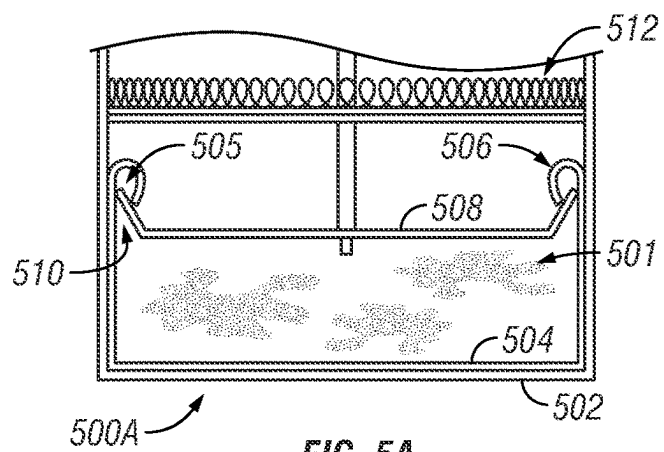
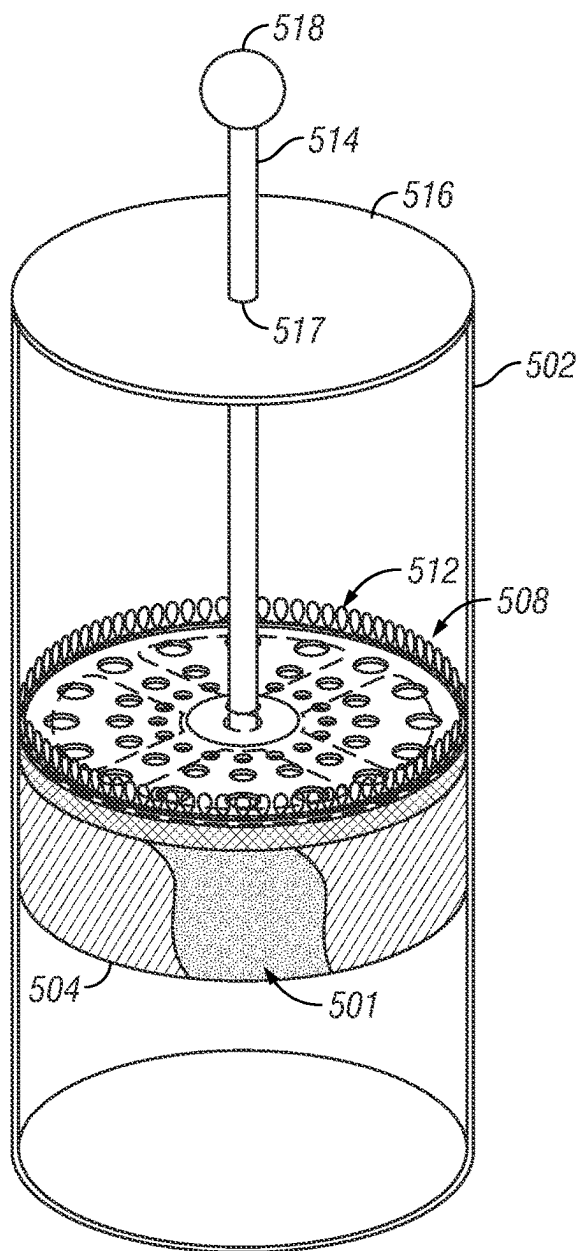


FIG. 4B



500B



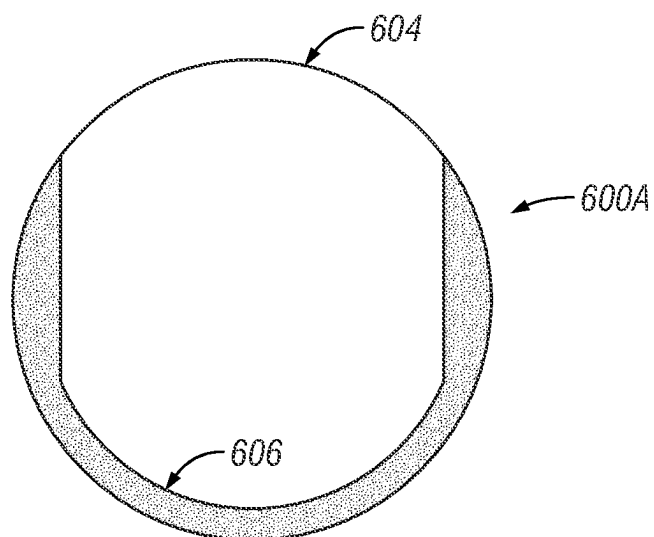


FIG. 6A

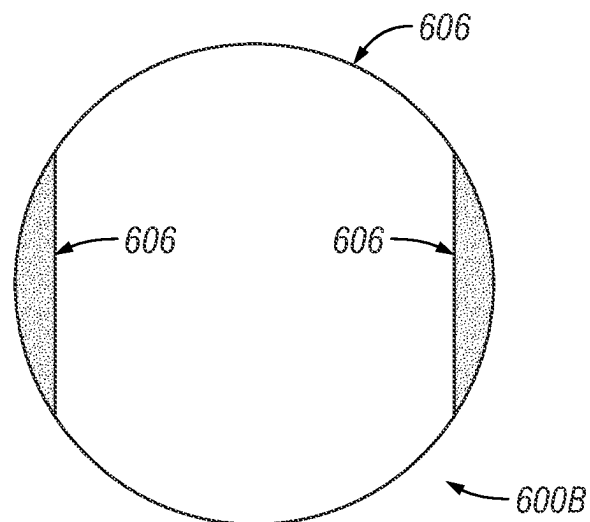


FIG. 6B

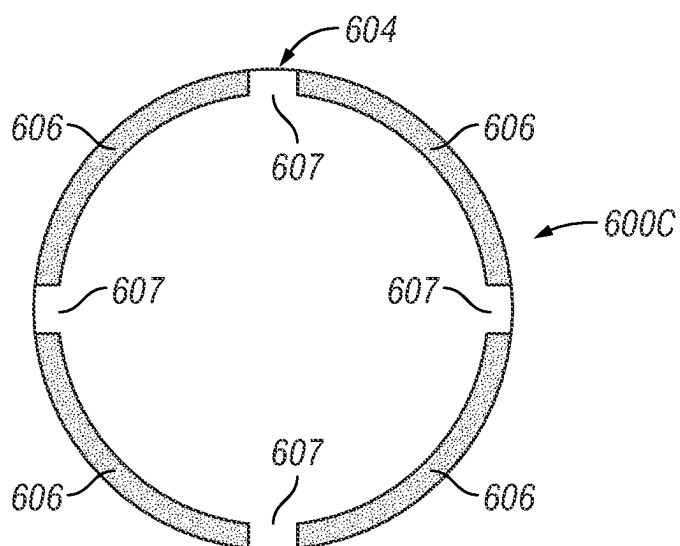


FIG. 6C

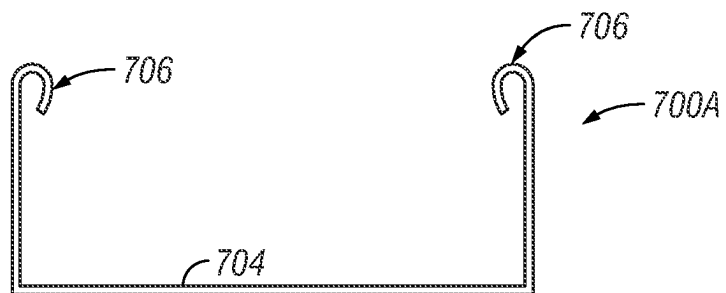


FIG. 7A

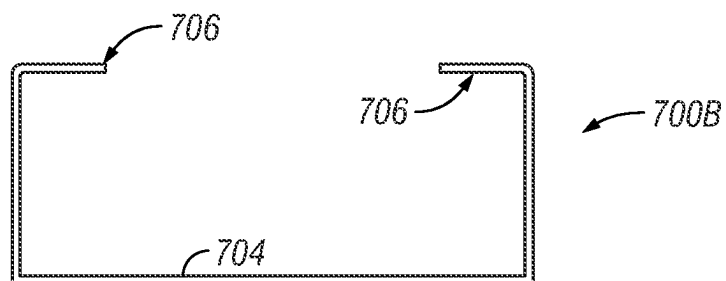


FIG. 7B

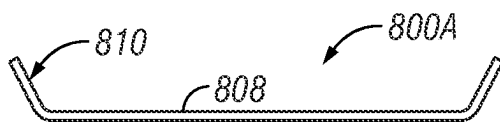


FIG. 8A

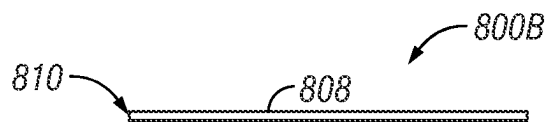


FIG. 8B

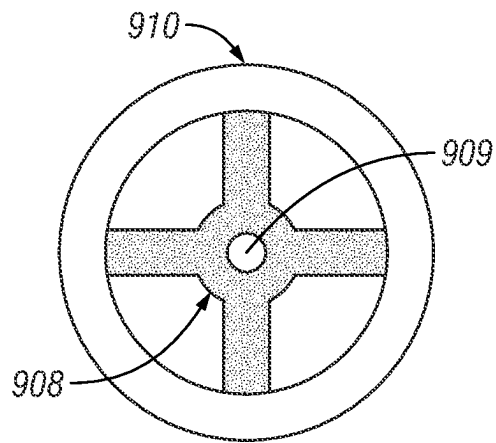


FIG. 9A

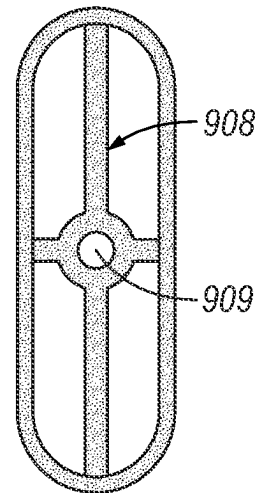


FIG. 9B

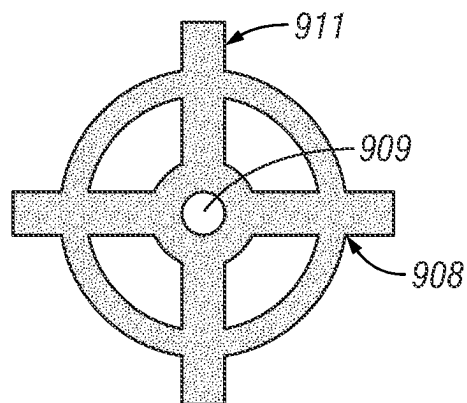


FIG. 9C

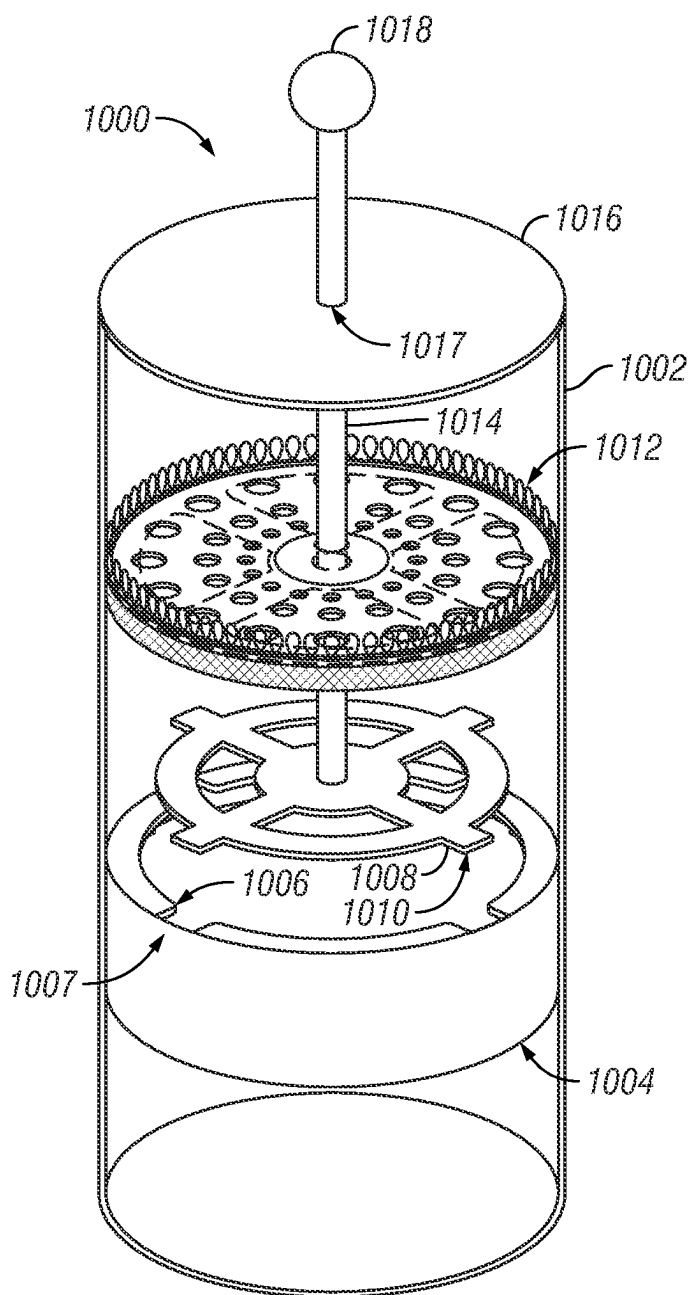


FIG. 10

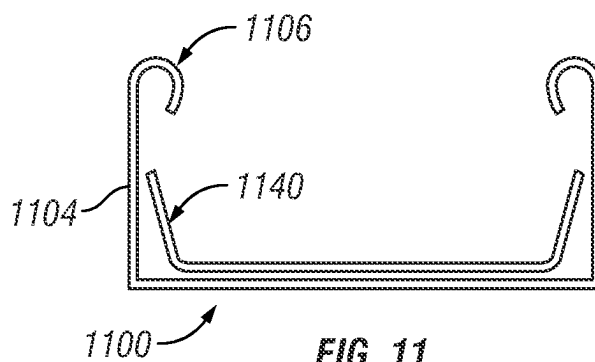


FIG. 11

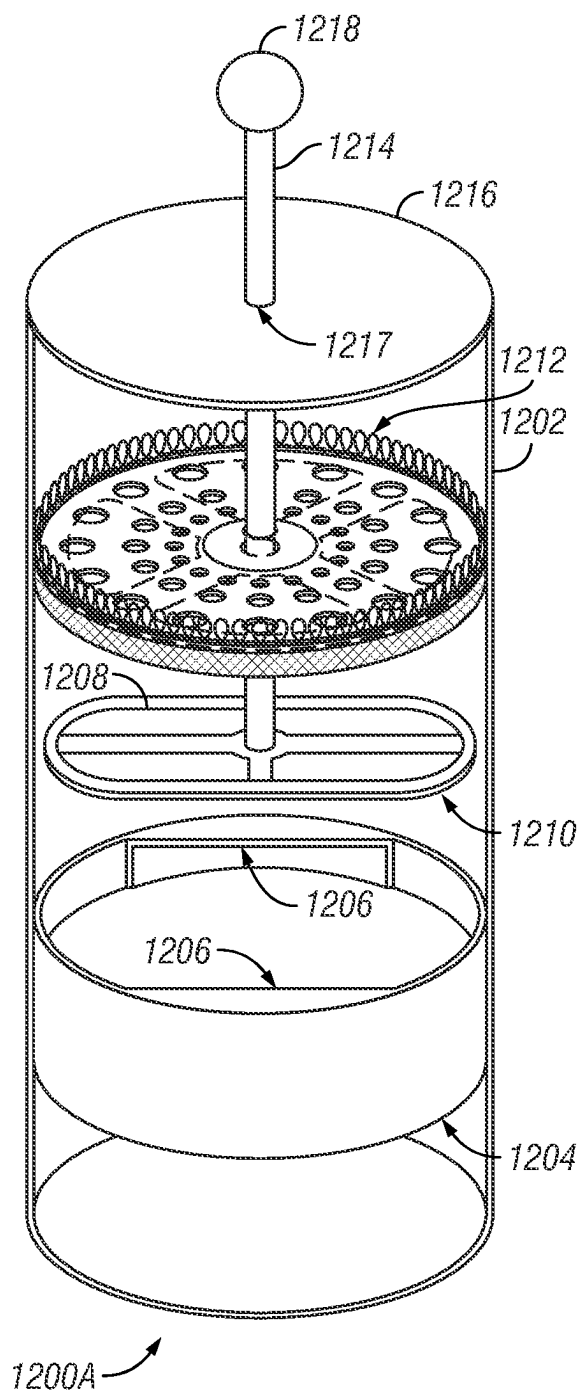


FIG. 12A

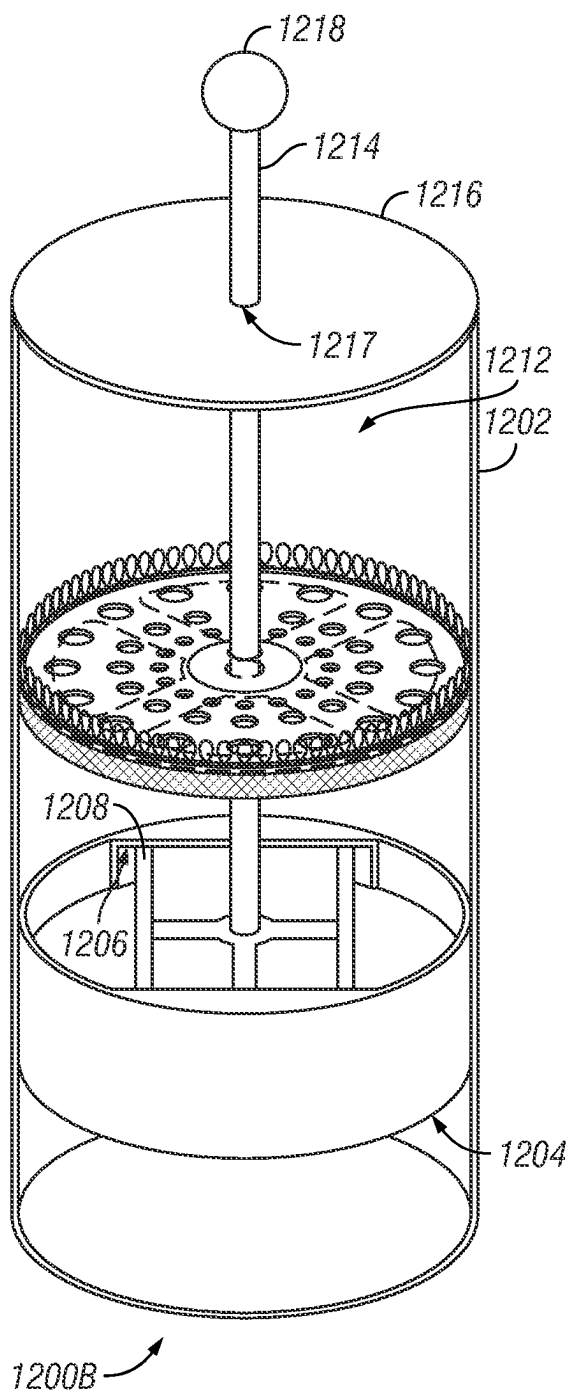


FIG. 12B

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FRENCH COFFEE PRESS**CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATION**

This application is a continuation application of U.S. Non-Provisional application Ser. No. 17/081,951, filed on Oct. 27, 2020, which is a continuation application of U.S. Non-Provisional application Ser. No. 15/790,964 filed Oct. 23, 2017, which claims the benefit of and priority to U.S. Provisional Application No. 62/412,130 filed Oct. 24, 2016, the disclosure of which is incorporated herein by reference.

FIELD OF THE DISCLOSURE

The present invention generally relates to the field of a coffee or brewed drink maker. Specifically in its preferred embodiments, the present invention discloses a French coffee press with a removable base.

BACKGROUND

The topic of coffee making is often thought of at the start of the day as a person gets ready with a cup of their favorite blend. There is also a variety of manners in which to make a cup of coffee. The one most quickly thought of by many people would be a trip to Starbucks® or a from a single cup coffee maker like a Keurig™. However, for those who like the experience or the science of coffee making they will often use alternative methods, such as drip brewing or steeping. One method of steeping includes the French press. In a French press, a piston with an attached filter is pushed through the steeping liquid to push the coffee grounds or other brewing material to the bottom of the cylinder in which it was brewed.

One of the major deficiencies of French coffee presses today is the difficulty in cleaning. The traditional French coffee press is a tall, skinny cylinder in which the coffee grounds are pressed down and compacted into the bottom of the cylinder. While brushes and water jets can assist in the cleaning process it is still difficult to remove the coffee grounds, in particular if a person is trying to avoid putting them down a sink, disposal, or dishwasher. Because of the difficulties in cleaning, one of the objectives of the present invention is to provide an improved French coffee press that is easily cleaned.

BRIEF SUMMARY

The present invention as embodied in an apparatus and method permits a user to brew coffee utilizing a French press, and steeping without the difficulties in cleaning that are commonplace with traditional French coffee presses. Thus, the present invention comprises a carafe, a lid for the carafe, a pressing rod, a filter system, and includes a locking base and a locking ring that is attached to the pressing rod. The locking ring and locking base provide the user with the ability to remove the coffee grounds from the carafe, without major difficulty.

The locking ring and locking base are secured together in a manner that allows the locking base to be removed from the carafe base. Once it is removed, then the locking base and locking ring can easily be separated from each other.

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

FIG. 1A provides a perspective view of a Prior Art French press coffee maker.

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FIG. 1B provides a perspective view of a Prior Art French press filter system.

FIG. 2A illustrates a perspective view of an improved French press coffee maker.

5 FIG. 2B illustrates a perspective view of an improved French press filter system.

FIG. 3A shows a perspective view of the improved French press filter system in the filtering stage.

10 FIG. 3B shows a perspective view of the improved French press filter system in the compression stage.

FIG. 3C shows a perspective view of the improved French press filter system in the removal stage.

FIG. 4A shows a side view of the improved French press coffee maker in use in the filtering stage.

15 FIG. 4B illustrates the beginning of the compression stage of the improved French press coffee maker.

FIG. 5A illustrates the securing stage of the improved French press coffee maker.

20 FIG. 5B shows a perspective view of the locking base being removed from the carafe of the improved French press coffee maker.

FIG. 6A shows a top view of a first preferred embodiment of the locking base of the improved French press coffee maker.

25 FIG. 6B shows a top view of a second preferred embodiment of the locking base of the improved French press coffee maker.

FIG. 6C shows a top view of a third preferred embodiment of the locking base of the improved French press coffee maker.

30 FIG. 7A illustrates a side view of a first preferred embodiment of the locking base, and the locking base lip(s).

FIG. 7B illustrates a side view of a second preferred embodiment of the locking base, and the locking base lip(s).

35 FIG. 8A illustrates a side view of a first preferred embodiment of the locking ring, and the locking ring lip(s).

FIG. 8B illustrates a side view of a second preferred embodiment of the locking ring, and the locking ring lip(s).

40 FIG. 9A shows the top view of a first preferred embodiment of the locking ring, and the locking ring lip(s).

FIG. 9B shows the top view of a second preferred embodiment of the locking ring, and the locking ring lip(s).

FIG. 9C shows the top view of a third preferred embodiment of the locking ring, and the locking ring lip(s).

45 FIG. 10 illustrates a perspective view of a first alternative embodiment of the improved French press coffee maker.

FIG. 11 shows a side view of the locking base with removable grounds container.

50 FIG. 12A shows a perspective view of an alternative embodiment of the locking ring lip(s) and the locking base lip(s) in the filtering stage.

FIG. 12B illustrates a perspective view of an alternative embodiment of the locking ring lip(s) and the locking base lip(s) in the removal stage.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

In FIG. 1A a traditional French press coffee maker **100A** is presented. For a coffee drinker who is a purest a French press is one of the best ways to brew coffee. The carafe **2** is filled with your most delicious blend of ground coffee beans, the hot water, and the grounds are now ready to be filtered away by the filter system **12** after the desired brewing time has been completed. The filter system **12** is connected to the pressing rod **14** through known methods of connection such as one-piece manufacturing, press fit, or threaded connector. In some designs, there is also the pressing rod bulb **18** that

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can be connected to the pressing rod **14** by similar methods as the filter system **12**. The carafe **2** and the carafe lid **16** help to prevent heat from escaping or the freshly brewed coffee from spilling from the inevitable bump. In addition, the carafe lid **16** provides stability to the press rod **14** during operation of the French press coffee maker.

The components **100B** of the French press filter system **12** are seen in FIG. 1B. The French press filter system **12** is comprised of the upper retainer ring **22** that typically has a spring or other mechanism around the outer edge of the upper retainer ring **22** to assist in pressing the mesh filter **24** to the inner wall of the carafe **2**. This pressing of the mesh filter **24** to the inner wall allows there to be some amount of pressure on the mesh filter **24**, and the inner wall of the carafe **2**, in order to prevent the coffee grounds or other brewing material from slipping around the mesh filter and returning to the filtered liquid. In addition, both the upper retainer ring **22** and the lower retainer ring **26** are an open design (holes or spokes) and not completely solid in order to allow the coffee or other liquid to flow through the mesh filter **24**. Neither the upper retaining ring **22** nor the lower retaining ring **26** perform any filtering. The mesh filter **24** is placed between the upper retaining ring **22** and the lower retaining ring **26** to provide it support as it is pushed through the brewing coffee in order to filter the coffee grounds from the liquid brewed coffee.

In FIG. 2A, the improved French coffee press **200A** can be seen in a perspective view and in a partially pressed state. Starting from the outside, the carafe **202** can be made of any material capable of handling hot or cold liquids, such as glass, or stainless steel. Inside and fit to the bottom of the carafe **202** is a locking base **204** designed to capture brewing materials (not shown) at the end of the brewing process and assist in removing them from the carafe **202**. The locking base **204** is made of a heat tolerant material that allows the locking base **204** to be semi-rigid. The locking base **204** is rigid except for the locking base lip(s) **206**. The locking base lip(s) **206** are flexible enough to allow a locking ring lip(s) **210** to pass by and secure a locking ring **208** within the locking base **204** and the locking base lip(s) **206** for removal of the locking base **204** from the carafe **202**.

The locking ring lip(s) **210** is the outer edge of the locking ring **208**, which is made of a material that provides rigid strength and allows the locking ring lip(s) **210** to be flexible. In addition to the locking ring **208**, there is also a filter system **212** in a preferred embodiment. While typically constructed of metal, the filter system **212** can also be constructed of plastics, glass, or other materials. The locking ring **208** and the filter system **212** in a preferred embodiment will be in close relation with each other, allowing the filter system **212** to filter brewing materials (not shown) and assist in pushing them into the locking base **204** at the end of the brewing process. When the locking ring **208** and locking ring lip(s) **210** engage with the locking base **204** and locking base lip(s) **206**, a secure latching occurs allowing a user to remove the locking base **204** and captured brewing materials (not shown) from the carafe **202** easily. The locking ring **208** and the locking ring lip(s) **210** can be made of the same or a similar material as the locking base **204** and the locking base lip(s) **206**. The bottom or a portion of the sides of the locking base **204** can be made of a solid or fine mesh material that would allow liquid to pass but will not allow any brewing material to leave the locking base **204**. The mesh or solid material could make up a portion or the entire bottom or wall of the locking base **204**. The material of the

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locking ring **208** and the locking base **204** also allow the locking ring **208** to be removably attached to the locking base **204**.

The filter system **212** and the locking ring **208** are attached to a pressing rod **214** via a threaded connection or a press fit connection. In one embodiment, the filter system **212** would be attached to a threaded portion of the pressing rod **214**, and adjacent to that threaded portion would be a second threaded portion of smaller diameter for the locking ring **208** to attach to. However, in alternative embodiments the locking ring **208** could be made of one piece manufacture with the filtering system **212**, or be connected to the pressing rod **214** through other methods of connection.

In FIG. 2B the improved French press filter system **200B** components could be retrofitted to any traditional French press coffee maker along with other pieces of the improved French press **200A**. One embodiment of the improved French press filter system **200B** is comprised of the upper retainer ring **222**, the mesh filter **224**, the lower retaining ring **226**, and the locking ring **208**. It is noted that there could be a plurality of upper retainer rings, a plurality of mesh filters, and a plurality of lower retaining rings in the improved French press filter system **200B**. The upper retainer ring **222** typically has a spring or other mechanism around the outer edge of the upper retainer ring **222** to assist in pressing the mesh filter **224** to the inner wall of the carafe **202**. This pressing of the mesh filter **224** to the inner wall allows there to be some amount of pressure on the mesh filter **224**, and the inner wall of the carafe **202**, in order to prevent the coffee grounds or other brewing material from slipping around the mesh filter and returning to the filtered liquid. The mesh filter **224** can be comprised of a single or multiple layers of filter material, such as wire mesh or replaceable organic material to provide the majority of the filtering, though other components can aid even if not designed to aid in the filtering process. The mesh filter **224** is placed between the upper retaining ring **222** and the lower retaining ring **226** to provide it support as it is pushed through the brewing coffee in order to filter the coffee grounds from the liquid brewed coffee. Both the upper retainer ring **222** and the lower retainer ring **226** are an open design (holes or spokes) and not completely solid in order to allow the coffee or other liquid to flow through the mesh filter **224**. Neither the upper retaining ring **222** nor the lower retaining ring **226** are designed perform any filtering. Likewise, the locking ring **208** can be an open design (spokes) and not completely solid in order to allow the coffee or other liquid to flow unimpeded so that only the mesh filter **224** performs any filtering. In addition, the locking ring **208** can be connected to or manufactured together with the lower retaining ring **226** to form a replaceable piece for traditional French press filter systems. All of these components are connected to the pressing rod **214** through a form of connection such as a threading, press fit, or manufactured as one piece.

Returning to FIG. 2A, the pressing rod **214** is used to press the filter system **212** and locking ring **208** in tandem through the liquid (not shown) being brewed to remove the brewing materials (not shown) from the liquid. The pressing rod **214** in a preferred embodiment is constructed of metal, but in alternative embodiments, can also be constructed of plastic, glass, or other hard material that is capable of withstanding the hot or cold liquid temperatures and the force required to securely mate the locking ring **208** and the locking base **204**. The pressing rod **214** passes through the carafe lid **216** at the carafe lid opening **217**. The carafe lid **216** is mated with the carafe **202**, through a threaded or press

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fit connection in preferred embodiments, additionally other methods of securing a liquid within an enclosed volume could also be used. In some embodiments, the carafe 202 or the carafe lid 216 may also have an opening to allow the filtered liquid to be poured from the carafe 202 or the carafe 202 may have a pour spout. The carafe lid 216 can be made of the same material as the carafe 202 or a different material. In order to allow the carafe lid 216 to be removed from the pressing rod 214, there is the securing bulb 218, however in other embodiments the securing bulb 218 may not be removable from the pressing rod 214, as the carafe lid 216 can be removed from the lower end of the pressing rod 214 when the filtering system 212 and the locking ring 208 are removed. The securing bulb 218 is attached to the pressing rod 214 through known methods of attachment such as, but not limited to a threaded or a press fitting manner.

FIG. 3A illustrates the filter stage 300A of the improved French press. During the filtering process, the filter system 312 strains and filters the brewed materials, such as coffee grounds or tea leaves, away from the brewed liquid. Some level of downward pressure 330 must be applied to the pressing rod 314 in order to move the combined filter system 312 and locking 308 through the liquid. As the locking ring 308 gets closer to the locking base 304, the locking ring lip(s) 310 begins to mate with the locking base lip(s) 306.

In FIG. 3B the compressing stage 300B of the improved French press is shown. At the end of the filtering stage 300A, the locking ring lip(s) 310 and the locking base lip(s) 306 are touching along the desired mating points. In order to move the locking ring 308 through the compression stage 300B there must be a specific amount of downward pressure 332 placed on the pressing rod 314 in an amount to compress the locking base lip(s) 306 enough to allow the locking ring 308 and locking ring lip(s) 310 to pass into the void of the locking base 304. Once enough downward pressure 332 is used to move the locking ring lip(s) 310 past the compressed locking base lip(s) 306 then the locking base lip(s) 306 will decompress, thus allowing the decompressed locking ring lip(s) 310 to be secured against the locking base lip(s) 306 during the removal stage.

FIG. 3C illustrates the removal stage 300C of the improved French press. When the locking ring lip(s) (not shown) are within the void of the locking base 304, and both the locking ring lip(s) (not shown) and the locking base lip(s) 306 have decompressed then the removal stage 300C can begin. The locking ring lip(s) (not shown) can be used to pull, when an upward force 334 is applied via the pressing rod 314, on the underside of the locking base lip(s) 306 in order to remove the locking base 304 from the carafe (not shown). In a preferred embodiment, the locking ring 308 will rest within the locking base 304, and the filter system 312 will be resting on top of the locking base lip(s) 306, thus providing a way for the majority of the filtered brewing material to be channeled into the locking base 304.

In FIG. 4A the improved coffee press 400A is being used to remove brewing materials 401 from the brewed liquid 403, in a filter stage similar to that of FIG. 3A. As pressure is applied to the securing bulb 418, and the pressing rod 414, which slides through the opening in the carafe lid 416, the filter system 412 and locking ring 408 are moved through the brewed liquid 403. The filtering system 412 in some embodiments may be attached to the pressing rod 414 at a first connection point 421, and the locking ring 408 is attached at a second connection point 420. The connection points 420, 421 may be a press fit, or threaded connection point, or alternatively could also be of a single piece manufacturing design. As the brewed liquid 403 is separated

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from the brewing material 401, the brewing material 401 is driven towards the locking base 404 by the filter system 412. In addition, in some embodiments the locking ring 408 provides some assistance in the driving of the brewed materials towards the locking base 404 without providing filtering, though alternatively it may also be combined with the filtering system 412 to provide filtering as well.

In FIG. 4B, the compression stage of the locking ring 408 and locking base 404 of the improved coffee press 400B is shown. As the locking ring 408 approaches the locking base 404, the locking ring lip(s) 410 and the locking base lip(s) 406 compress against each other. With sufficient pressure applied to the pressing rod 414 and securing bulb 418, the locking ring lip(s) 410 will be compressed inward towards the pressing rod 414, and the locking base lip(s) 406 will be compressed outward towards the wall(s) of the carafe 402. As the locking ring 408 is pushed through the compressed stage it leads to the secured stage shown in FIG. 5A.

As seen in FIGS. 5A & 5B, the secured stage of the improved coffee press 500A will allow the locking base 504 to be removed from the carafe 502. One of the improvements of the improved coffee press 500A is the collection of the brewing materials 501 in the locking base 504, thus making the brewing materials 501 easier to remove from the carafe 502. With the locking ring 508 being pushed via the pressing rod 514 through the compression stage 400B, to the securing stage 500A, the locking ring lip(s) 510 decompress along with decompressing of the locking base lip(s) 506 in order to form a secure connection when a pulling force is applied to the pressing rod 514. When a user pulls on the pressing rod 514, in order to remove the locking base 504, the locking ring lip(s) 510 slips into the opening 505 formed between the curved portion of the locking base lip(s) 506, and the locking base 504. Thus providing leverage for the removal of the locking base 504 from the carafe 502. In a preferred embodiment illustrated, the locking ring lip(s) 510 slips inside the opening 505.

During the removal stage of the improved coffee press 500B, the secured connection formed by the locking base lip(s) 506, and the locking ring lip(s) 510, in the opening 505 assist the user in removing the locking base 504 via the pressing rod 514. In a preferred embodiment, the filtering system 512 rests on top of or just above the locking base lip(s) 506 during the removal stage 500B, thus allowing the uncaptured brewing material 501 to be captured between the filtering system 512 and the locking base 504. The result of the capture of the brewing materials 501, is the clean carafe 502 seen in the lower portion of FIG. 5B.

In FIGS. 6A-6C a top view of locking base 604 and locking base lip(s) 606 in a set of advantageous embodiments is shown. In FIG. 6A, a first preferred embodiment 600A is illustrated that allows the pressing rod (not shown) and the locking ring (not shown) to be shifted to one side to allow the locking ring to be released from the locking base 604 and the locking base lip(s) 606. In a second preferred embodiment 600B, there are two locking base lip(s) 606 shown. In this embodiment the pressing rod (not shown) and the locking ring (not shown) can be shifted to either of the two sides to allow the locking ring to be released from the locking base 604 and the locking base lip(s) 606. In a third preferred embodiment 600C, four locking base lip(s) 606 are shown. In this embodiment, the locking ring (not shown) can be released from the locking base 604 by aligning the locking ring lip(s) (not shown) with the locking base gaps 607. While embodiments have been illustrated that utilize one, two or four lip(s) or wings, other embodiments that include at least one lip(s) or wings are also possible. It could

also be understood by someone skilled in the art how the locking base **604** and locking ring (not shown) connection could be achieved through additional means, such as, a threaded configuration, a press fit configuration, a snapping configuration, or other manners known for making a secure physical connection.

A side view of the locking base **704** and locking base lip(s) **706** are seen in FIGS. 7A & 7B. The locking base **704** is configured to capture brewing material (not shown), such as, coffee grounds, tealeaves, pulp from fruits, or other brewable elements. In a first preferred embodiment **700A**, the locking base lip(s) **706** curve downward from the upward wall of the locking base **704**. The curve of the locking base lip(s) **706** allows for the compression that is created when the locking ring (not shown) is pushed through compression stage to the securing stage, resulting in the locking ring being in the void of the locking base **704**. In a second preferred embodiment **700B**, the locking base lip(s) **706** are at or below a ninety-degree angle from the wall of the locking base **704**.

In FIGS. 8A & 8B, two side views of the locking ring **808** are illustrated. A first preferred embodiment **800A**, includes locking ring lip(s) **810** that are upturned from the plane of the locking ring **808**. In order to assist in the capture of brewing materials (not shown) the upturned locking ring lip(s) **810** aid in the compression of the locking base lip(s) (not shown) as the locking ring **808** is moved from the compression stage to the securing stage. In a second preferred embodiment **800B**, the locking ring **808** and the locking ring lip(s) **810** are in the same plane. This advantageous embodiment works best with the locking base (not shown) with straight or slightly angled locking ring lip(s) (not shown), however it can also be used with the curved locking base lip(s) embodiment as well.

A top view of the locking ring **908** is shown in FIGS. 9A-9C. In a first preferred embodiment **900A**, the locking ring **908** is configured to closely match with the inner dimensions of the carafe **902**, though along two opposing edges there is a gap **911** between the edge of the locking ring **908** and the carafe **902** to allow for the locking ring lip(s) **910** to compress and become secure against the locking base lip(s) (not shown). In a second preferred embodiment **900B**, there are large gaps **911** between the carafe **902** and the locking ring **908**, on opposing sides. This second preferred embodiment **902** also is configured to work with the first and second preferred embodiments of the locking base (not shown). However, it would be understood by someone with skill in the art that multiple embodiments and configurations are possible. In a third preferred embodiment **900C**, the locking ring **908** is shown with four wings that form the locking ring lip(s) **910**. The wings extend outward from the pressing rod connection **909**. While illustrated in this advantageous embodiment with four wings, the improved coffee press is not limited to four wings, there is to be at least one wing and up to as many necessary to provide support in removing the locking base (not shown).

In FIG. 10, an alternative advantageous embodiment of the improved coffee press **1000** is shown. In this alternative embodiment **1000**, the locking ring **1008** is comprised of four wings that form the locking ring lip(s) **1010**. In addition, the locking base **1004** is comprised of four locking base lip(s) **1006** that are turned slightly downward, and four locking base lip(s) gaps **1007**. To start the brewing process the carafe **1002** is filled with brewing material (not shown) and liquid. Once the liquid has been poured into the carafe **1002** the brewing process begins for the proper amount of time. At any time after the brewing process has been started,

the pressing rod **1014**, locking ring **1008** and filter system **1012** combination is inserted to the carafe **1002** and attached to the carafe **1002** via the carafe lid **1016**. As a pressure is applied to the pressing rod **1014**, the filter system **1012** and the locking ring **1008** move in tandem further downward into the carafe **1002**, removing the brewing material (not shown) from the liquid (not shown). Once the locking ring **1008** has made contact with the locking base **1004**, the locking base lip(s) **1006** and the locking ring lip(s) **1010** are touching. The next step is for the user to increase pressure in order to cause the compression necessary to allow the locking ring **1008** and locking ring lip(s) **1010** to move through the locking base lip(s) **1006**. In addition, a user may also rotate the pressing rod **1014** in order to rotate the locking ring **1008** so that it aligns with the locking base lip(s) gaps **1007** of the locking base **1004**. Once the locking ring **1008** and locking ring lip(s) **1010** have moved past the locking base lip(s) **1006**, and the brewing materials are captured in the locking base **1004**, the locking base **1004** and the locking ring **1008** can be secured together.

In FIG. 11, a side view of the locking base **1104** is shown with a supplemental base **1140** is shown that can be both removable and/or disposable. The supplemental base **1140** is designed to give the user a way to decrease the amount of cleaning that would be required for the locking base **1104**. As coffee grounds collect in the supplemental base **1140**, the grounds then do not collect in the locking base, thus allowing the locking base **1104** to be used multiple times without cleaning if so desired. This supplemental base **1140** can be made of paper, metal, plastic, or other organic or synthetic materials.

In FIGS. 12A and 12B, an alternative advantageous embodiment of the improved coffee press **1200A** and **1200B** is shown in different stages. The locking base lip(s) **1206** in these embodiment are the straight or slightly downturned version, in order to assist the removal of the locking base **1204**. In addition, the locking ring **1208** is an oblong oval shape, and a straight plane that is configured to move through, the opening created by the locking base lip(s) **1206** when the locking ring **1208** is rotated so that it will move between the locking base lip(s) **1206** with ease. The combination of the dual locking base lip(s) **1206**, and the oblong locking ring **1208** allow the user to remove the locking base **1204**, by inserting the locking ring **1208** into the locking base **1204** through the gap between the locking base lip(s) or compression and rotating until the locking ring lip(s) **1210** are below the locking base lip(s) **1206** as shown in FIG. 12B. The filtering system **1212** is set some distance above the locking ring **1208**, on the pressing rod **1214** in order to remove the remaining brewing materials (not shown) from the liquid during the removal stage. In a preferred embodiment, the filtering system **1212** rests on top of or just above the locking base lip(s) **1206** during the removal stage, thus allowing the brewing material (not shown) to be captured between the filtering system **1212** and the locking base **1204**.

The description of the present invention has been presented for purposes of illustration and description, and is not intended to be exhaustive or limited to the invention in the form disclosed. Many modifications and variations will be apparent to those of ordinary skill in the art. The embodiment was chosen and described in order to best explain the principles of the invention, the practical application, and to enable others of ordinary skill in the art to understand the invention for various embodiments with various modifications as are suited to the particular use contemplated. It will be understood by one of ordinary skill in the art that numerous variations will be possible to the disclosed

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embodiments without going outside the scope of the invention as disclosed in the claims.

I claim:

1. A French press filter system for use with a carafe comprising:

- a filtering system slidably engaged to a pressing rod, wherein the pressing rod comprises an interface for holding the filtering system in place;
- a locking ring fixedly attached to a terminal end of the pressing rod; and
- a locking base configured to engage with the locking ring such that the locking base may be removed from the carafe, wherein the locking base comprises a set of lips.

2. The French press filter system of claim 1, wherein the filtering system comprises an upper retaining ring.

3. The French press filter system of claim 1, wherein the filtering system comprises a filter mesh.

4. The French press filter system of claim 1, wherein the filtering system comprises a lower retaining ring.

5. The French press filter system of claim 1, wherein the filtering system comprises an upper retaining ring removably coupled to a pressing rod; a filter mesh located below the upper retaining ring; a lower retaining ring located below the filter mesh and removably engaged with the upper retaining ring to provide support for the filter mesh.

6. The French press filter system of claim 1, wherein the locking base is sized to fit within the carafe with such that brewing material cannot pass between the locking base and the carafe.

7. The French press filter system of claim 1, wherein the set of lips are flexible.

8. The French press filter system of claim 1, wherein the locking ring comprises a set of lips.

9. The French press filter system of claim 8, wherein the set of lips are flexible.

10. A French press filter system comprising:

- an upper retaining ring slidably engaged to a pressing rod;
- a filter mesh slidably engaged to the pressing rod, the filter mesh located below the upper retaining ring;

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- a lower retaining ring slidably engaged to the pressing rod, the lower retaining ring being located below the filter mesh and removably engaged with the upper retaining ring to provide support for the filter mesh; and
- a locking ring fixedly attached to a terminal end of the pressing rod, wherein the locking ring is configured to engage with a locking base.

11. The French press filter system of claim 10, wherein the locking ring includes a lip along an outer edge of the locking ring.

12. The French press filter system of claim 11, wherein the lip is flexible.

13. The French press filter system of claim 10, wherein the locking base includes a flexible lip that allows the locking ring to pass through.

14. The French press filter system of claim 10, wherein the locking base is sized to fit within a carafe.

15. A French press apparatus comprising:

- a carafe;
- a filter system sized to fit within the carafe, the filter system including an upper retaining ring, a mesh filter below the upper retaining ring, a lower retaining ring supporting the mesh filter, and a locking ring below the lower retaining ring;
- a pressing rod slidably engaged to the filter system, wherein the locking ring is fixedly attached to a terminal end of the pressing rod; and
- a locking base configured to receiving the locking ring when the pressing rod is advanced downward.

16. The French press apparatus of claim 15, wherein the locking base is sized to fit within the carafe such that brewing material cannot pass between the locking base and the carafe.

17. The French press apparatus of claim 15, wherein the locking ring includes a lip that is flexible.

18. The French press apparatus of claim 15, wherein the locking base includes a lip that is flexible.

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